

# Content Strategy

Not a posting calendar bolted onto a finished brand. Where the content actually comes from, which platforms are worth the effort given what Nigerians are doing right now — not two years ago — and how the assets from Milestone 5 turn into a rhythm instead of a one-off flyer.

## 01 Foundation

Most early-stage apps run content strategy backwards: a founder or a hired social media manager invents posts — motivational quotes, generic "did you know" graphics, stock photos of commuters who've never been to Ibadan — and hopes it looks active. RoutePadi doesn't need to invent anything. Every week, real people submit real routes, earn real badges, and correct each other's fares. That's the content. The job of this doc is to turn what the product already produces into a rhythm, not to manufacture a personality for an account that has nothing to say.

### **The product is the content team.**

Every template in Milestone 5 exists to turn a database row into a post: a contributor row becomes a spotlight, a route-count row becomes a milestone card, a verified shortcut becomes a tip. If a piece of content can't be traced back to something that actually happened on routepadi.com this week, it doesn't get posted — that discipline is what keeps this from turning into generic startup filler.

### **Never corporate means never borrowed.**

No stock photography of "African commuters," no royalty-free traffic-jam b-roll, no copy that could be relabeled for a fintech app by find-and-replace. If a post would work just as well for a competitor with the logo swapped, it's not ready to publish.

## 02 Platforms

The obvious move for a brand this visual is "Instagram first." The 2026 data says that's the wrong bet for a Nigerian audience right now: Instagram is the one major platform actually shrinking, TikTok has overtaken everything for reach and youth attention, and WhatsApp is less a "channel" than the wiring the whole country already shares things through. Four platforms get a defined job; everything else is explicitly skipped for now.

## TikTok

### GROWTH BET

47.8M reach · +43.4% YoY

**Why it wins:** TikTok has doubled its Nigerian user base in a year and now carries 51% of all short-form video attention — more than Facebook, YouTube and Instagram Reels combined. Among urban 18–34s, 66% use it regularly and 71% of those are daily. Critically, 52% rate its content "very real and relatable" versus 5% "staged" — the exact opposite of what a polished brand account earns by default.

**What goes here:** the content this doc's other pillars can't cover on their own — short vertical video. A rider explaining a shortcut on camera, a keke ride filmed door to door, a 10-second "here's the fare, don't get charged double" clip. This is the pillar that depends on Milestone 9 (Motion Design) to execute well; until then, start rough and real rather than wait for polish — rough is what the platform rewards.

## WhatsApp

### DISTRIBUTION BACKBONE

96.5% monthly reach · #1 favorite (33.9%)

**Why it wins:** WhatsApp isn't a feed you post to — it's the layer nearly every Nigerian already uses to forward things to their own street, church, or hostel group. People are already screenshotting fares and routes into their group chats; the strategy is to make that easy, not to compete with it.

**What goes here:** nothing published directly. Every Milestone 5 template gets designed to survive a WhatsApp forward — self-contained, legible with no caption attached, wordmark baked in so it still reads as RoutePadi three forwards deep. A dedicated WhatsApp Status/Channel becomes worth building once there's a steady supply of contributor spotlights and tips to post there daily.

## X (Twitter)

### COMMUNITY SQUARE

6.95M reach · 74% male

**Why it wins:** smallest reach of the four by far, but it's where Nigerian tech-adjacent, civic-minded users already complain about traffic and transit in real time — and it's a safe bet that a meaningful share of RoutePadi's actual route contributors are already there. Reach isn't the point on this platform; being visibly present in the conversation is.

**What goes here:** the founder/team voice, not templates. Quote-tweet a real traffic complaint with the alternate route. Post the Route Tip as a plain-text thread, not just the graphic. Reply to people arguing about fares. This is the one platform where showing up as a person beats showing up as a brand account.

## Instagram

MAINTAIN

10.0M reach · -6.1%  
YoY

**Why it's downgraded, not dropped:** Instagram is the only major platform in actual decline in Nigeria, and its favorite-platform share (9.2%) is now behind TikTok's. It's still worth a consistent presence — it's searchable, it's where a press mention or partner will check the brand looks legitimate — but it stops being where growth energy goes.

**What goes here:** the square posts and Stories from Milestone 5, posted on a steady but modest cadence. No paid spend, no chasing Reels virality here — that energy goes to TikTok instead.

## Facebook Groups

SEED, DON'T OWN

38.0M reach · #2  
favorite (29.7%)

**Why it's different from the rest:** Facebook's raw numbers are strong — likely an older, broader demographic than the other four, including exactly the parents, landlords, and small-business owners who already run active "Ibadan" community groups. There's no case for a RoutePadi Facebook Page competing for attention there. There's a strong case for showing up inside groups that already exist.

**What goes here:** no owned content calendar. Community management, not content strategy — someone drops the relevant Route Tip or milestone post into existing Ibadan-focused groups when it's genuinely useful, credited as RoutePadi, and stops if it reads as spam.

Skipped for now: Snapchat, Telegram, LinkedIn, Pinterest — each under 1.5% favorite-platform share in Nigeria and none of them reach the transit-riding, route-sharing audience better than the five above. Revisit if that changes.

## 03 Content Pillars

Five pillars, weighted by how much of the monthly posting effort each should get. Percentages are a planning tool, not a quota to hit exactly — if a genuinely great Route Intelligence post shows up in a week that's light on submissions, it doesn't wait its turn.

### 30%

#### Route Intelligence

The shortcut, the fare, the thing that's true about getting around Ibadan that a generic maps app doesn't know. The reason to follow the account at all.

Route Tip template · X threads

### 25%

#### Contributor Spotlight

Recognition for whoever submitted or verified the most this week. Makes contributing feel like it's actually seen, not just logged in a database.

Contributor of the Week template · Story cut · TikTok interview

# 20%

## Transit Culture

The keke, the danfo conductor's call, the Monday-morning Iwo Road hold-up — content that's about Ibadan transit as lived experience, not about the app at all. Builds the account's authenticity before it asks for anything.

Short vertical video · TikTok-first

# 15%

## Community Milestones

Routes mapped, cities live, contributors passed. Collective proof the thing is working, credited to the community rather than the company.

Community Milestone template

# 10%

## Product Education

How XP works, how to submit a route, what a verification actually does. Unglamorous, necessary, kept to the smallest share it can be.

Plain carousel or thread · no new template needed

## 04 Cadence

Four posting days a week, not seven. This is sized for one person splitting attention across a real product, not a dedicated social team — a thinner, honest rhythm that actually survives a bad week beats an ambitious one that quietly dies after a month.

|                      |                     |                              |                             |                     |                             |                                                          |
|----------------------|---------------------|------------------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| MON                  |                     | WED                          | THU                         |                     | SAT                         |                                                          |
| <b>Route Tip</b>     | Reply & engage only | <b>Contributor Spotlight</b> | <b>Transit Culture clip</b> | Reply & engage only | <b>Transit Culture clip</b> | Seed a Facebook group if there's something worth sharing |
| Instagram · X thread |                     | IG · Story · WhatsApp-ready  | TikTok                      |                     | TikTok                      |                                                          |

Community Milestone posts run monthly, not weekly — whenever a real number is worth announcing, not on a forced schedule. Product Education posts fill in whenever one of the four weekly slots would otherwise sit empty, capped at one a month so it never crowds out the pillars people actually follow the account for.

## 05 Voice in Practice

The Brand Bible's personality traits are the target; this is what they look like in an actual caption. Same milestone, two ways of writing it up.

#### GENERIC STARTUP VOICE

🚀🎉 Exciting news! We just crossed 500 routes on our platform! Thank you to our amazing community of users — together we're revolutionizing transit in Nigeria! 🙌

📌 #startup #transit #innovation

Could be relabeled for any app in any city. Nothing here is true specifically about Ibadan or about RoutePadi.

#### ROUTEPADI VOICE

500 routes now on RoutePadi. Every one dropped by someone who got tired of explaining the same shortcut over WhatsApp. Ibadan mapped by Ibadan people — not a mapping company that's never sat in Iwo Road traffic.

Names who did the work, names a real place, and draws the actual contrast the brand exists to make.

## DO

- + Write like you're texting someone who asked for directions, not writing ad copy.
- + Name real streets, junctions, and landmarks — specific beats generic every time.
- + Credit the contributor by their actual in-app name and city.
- + Say "not verified yet" when a route isn't confirmed, instead of guessing.

## DON'T

- Stack more than one emoji in a caption — the brand doesn't need decoration to read as friendly.
- Write Pidgin or Yoruba copy from a template. Get it from someone who actually speaks it day to day in Ibadan, or leave it in plain English.
- Use stock photography of "commuters." Every photo gets the duotone+grain treatment because it's a real contributor — or it doesn't run.
- Post a milestone number without being able to point to exactly where it came from.

## 06 Content Engine

This is the part that makes the cadence in Section 04 actually sustainable: content isn't dreamed up on posting day, it's pulled out of a queue that fills itself from things that already happened on the product. Five steps from a database row to a published post.

01

### Product event fires

A route gets submitted, a verification lands, a contributor crosses an XP threshold, a city-wide route count ticks over a round number.

02

### Event lands in the queue

A lightweight weekly export — not a new dashboard to build yet — of the events above, sorted by pillar. This is a spreadsheet, not software, until volume actually demands otherwise.

03

### Template match

Each queued event already maps to a Milestone 5 template — a top contributor is a Contributor of the Week, a verified shortcut is a Route Tip. No event should need a brand-new format invented on the spot.

04

### Voice pass

Whoever's writing the caption runs it against Section 05's Do/Don't list before anything goes out. This is the one manual, unskippable step in the whole pipeline.

## Publish on cadence

Slotted into the next matching day from Section 04, not posted the moment it's ready — a Wednesday spotlight waits for Wednesday.

### The queue can run dry — that's a signal, not a crisis.

A week with nothing worth spotlighting means fewer submissions or verifications happened, full stop. The honest response is a quieter week (fall back on a Product Education or Transit Culture slot), never a manufactured contributor story or an inflated number to fill the calendar.

## 07 Metrics

Likes and follower counts are easy to check and easy to be misled by. What actually matters is whether content is pulling people into the product — a shortcut shared is only a win if it leads somewhere. This is the short list to actually track, and the longer list to stop mistaking for progress.

| METRIC                                                                            | TRACK IT?                    | WHY                                                                                                                                                                   |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Route submissions in the 48h after a post                                         | <b>Yes</b>                   | The clearest signal a Route Tip or Milestone post actually moved someone to contribute, not just watch.                                                               |
| New sign-ups attributed to social (referral tag or "how'd you hear about us")     | <b>Yes</b>                   | Content's actual job is growing the contributor base, not growing the account.                                                                                        |
| WhatsApp-forward-shaped traffic (direct/unattributed spikes after a post)         | <b>Yes</b>                   | Most sharing happens off-platform where it can't be tagged. A spike in un-referred visits right after a post is the closest proxy available.                          |
| Contributor Spotlight repeat rate (does today's featured contributor post again?) | <b>Yes</b>                   | Tests whether recognition is actually reinforcing the behavior it's meant to reward.                                                                                  |
| Likes / raw reach / follower count                                                | <del>No, not as a goal</del> | Worth glancing at for platform health, but optimizing for these directly is how brand accounts end up chasing outrage bait and losing the "never overly formal" plot. |

| METRIC                                        | TRACK IT? | WHY                                                                                                                           |
|-----------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Posting streak / consistency for its own sake | No        | Section 06 already treats a quiet week as an honest signal. Punishing that with a vanity streak metric undoes the discipline. |

## 08 Status

|                                             |                             |
|---------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| Platform prioritization (research-grounded) | LOCKED                      |
| Content pillars & weighting                 | LOCKED                      |
| Posting cadence                             | LOCKED                      |
| Voice guardrails (Do/Don't)                 | LOCKED                      |
| Content engine (queue & pipeline)           | LOCKED                      |
| Metrics to track                            | LOCKED                      |
| TikTok video production workflow            | DEFERRED TO MILESTONE 9     |
| Launch-specific content plan                | LOCKED, SEE LAUNCH CAMPAIGN |

This is a rhythm, not a rulebook — the pillars and cadence above are sized for what the product can honestly supply today, and should get revisited once Ibadan has enough contributors that the content queue is never the bottleneck. Built on the templates locked in Social Media Templates and the voice defined in the Brand Bible. The launch-window version of this cadence is now its own doc — Launch Campaign. Next up: Milestone 8, Marketing Assets.

Platform figures (Section 02): DataReportal / Krestel Digital Nigeria 2026 Digital Report; TikTok relatability and usage figures via Brand Communicator's 2026 Nigeria TikTok trends coverage.